ScanDesk Desktop 0.7.3 vs PaperPort Professional 14.7

Features and measured speed, side by side on the same PC. Prepared 2026-11-02 for Mark Brown, MD. ScanDesk 0.7.3 (released today) against PaperPort Professional 14.7.19464.100 (installed on the same machine).

1. The short version

5.6×
faster to a usable window at start (1.2 s vs 6.7 s)

7.8×
faster switching to a folder of 153 scanned PDFs (0.18 s vs 1.40 s)

2.5×
faster from double-click to the page on screen (1.24 s vs 3.1 s)

0 MB
of proprietary files: every document stays a plain PDF in a normal folder

ScanDesk does everything the office used PaperPort for day to day (scan, print into the desktop, folders and thumbnails, stacks, clean-up, annotate, fill forms, search, send), and adds what PaperPort never had: a review queue for suggested names, filing rules with preview and undo, a duplicate finder, search by meaning ("the eye clinic lease from two years ago"), an audit log, built-in verified updates and a converter for old PaperPort .max files. It is faster at every measured step. It uses more memory than PaperPort (about 230 MB with a document open against about 145 MB) because the PDF renderer, the OCR engine and the index all live in one 64-bit process; on any PC with 8 GB or more this is not noticeable.

What PaperPort still has that ScanDesk does not: PDF/A output and PDF portfolios, cloud, SharePoint and FTP connectors (left out on purpose: ScanDesk never talks to the network except for the update check you start), bundled OCR in many languages (ScanDesk ships English; other languages are a file drop), custom metadata fields (author, keywords), and native reading of .max files (ScanDesk converts them with PaperPort's own converter instead).

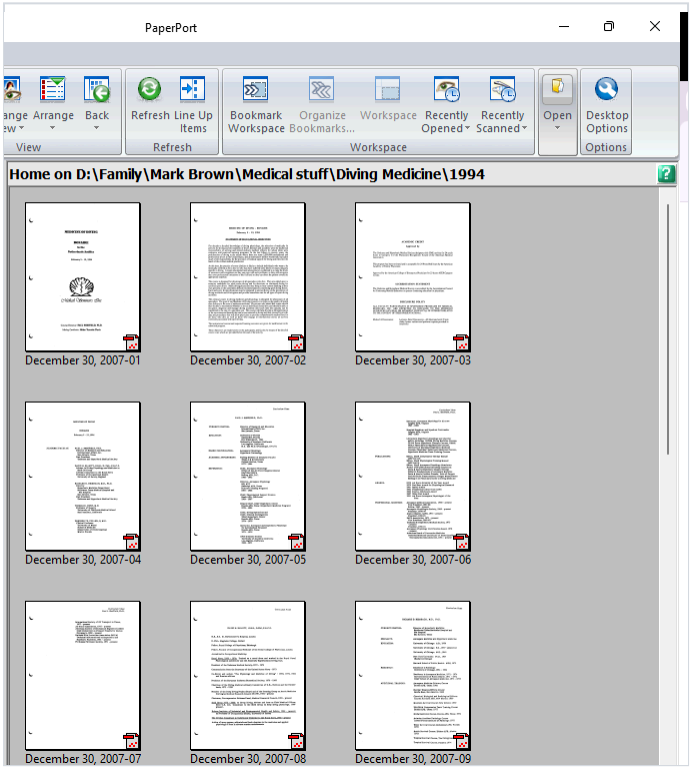
2. Speed, measured the same way on both

Method. Same PC (Intel Core i7-10700, 8 cores, 32 GB RAM, NVMe SSD, Windows 11 Pro 26300), same folder: *Home\Family\Mark Brown\Medical stuff\Diving Medicine\1994* on D:\OneDrive, 153 one-page scanned PDFs, all present on disk. Each product was driven by a script that timed the clock from the action (process start, click on the folder, double-click on the first document) until the window's picture stopped changing for 1.5 s (1 s for the viewer); that moment is reported as "settled" or "drawn". Three rounds each, medians shown, every round in the table. Both products had seen the folder before, so thumbnail caches were warm, except ScanDesk's first round, which started with an empty cache. Nothing else was running in the foreground. OCR, naming suggestions and the meaning index were switched off in ScanDesk so the two desktops did the same work; PaperPort has no such background work to turn off.

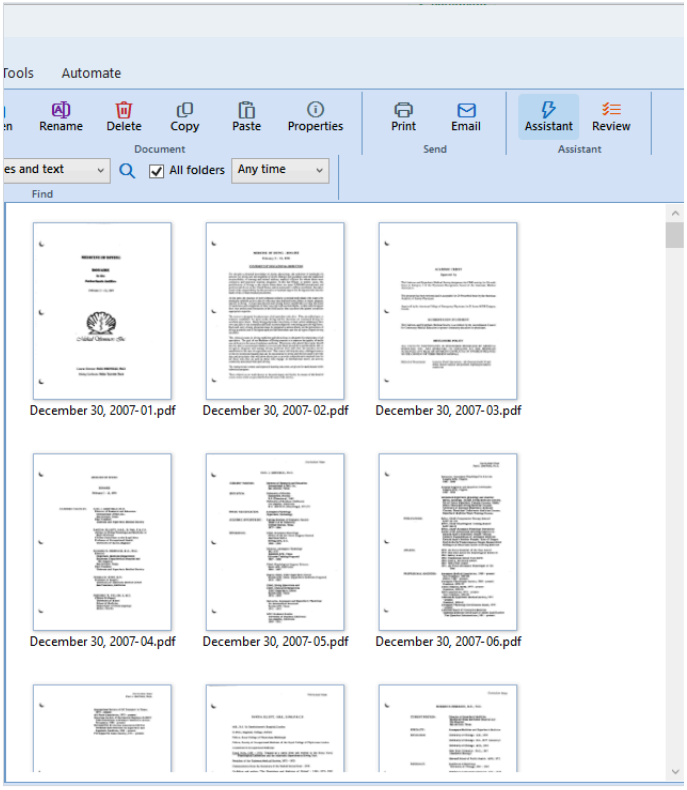
Step	PaperPort 14.7	ScanDesk 0.7.3	ScanDesk is	Rounds (PaperPort / ScanDesk)
Start until the main window is on screen	6.7 s	1.2 s	5.6× faster	6.0, 7.9, 6.7 / 1.7, 1.2, 1.1
Start until the folder of 153 PDFs is fully drawn (both reopen their last folder)	8.5 s	1.7 s	5.0× faster	7.7, 9.6, 8.5 / 2.5 (empty cache), 1.5, 1.7
Switch from the 1995 folder to the 1994 folder (153 PDFs) until drawn	1.40 s	0.18 s	7.8× faster	1.31, 1.44, 1.40 / 0.19, 0.17, 0.18

Double-click a document until the viewer window exists	2.8 s	0.14 s	20× faster	2.92, 2.77, 2.76 / 0.14, 0.12, 0.14
Double-click a document until the page is drawn and still	3.1 s	1.24 s	2.5× faster	3.16, 3.10, 3.09 / 1.23, 1.25, 1.24
Memory, desktop showing the folder	85 MB	168 MB	2.0× more	PaperPort: PaprPort.exe. ScanDesk: one process
Memory, desktop plus one document open in the viewer	144 MB	228 MB	1.6× more	PaperPort: 85 MB + PDF Viewer Plus 59 MB

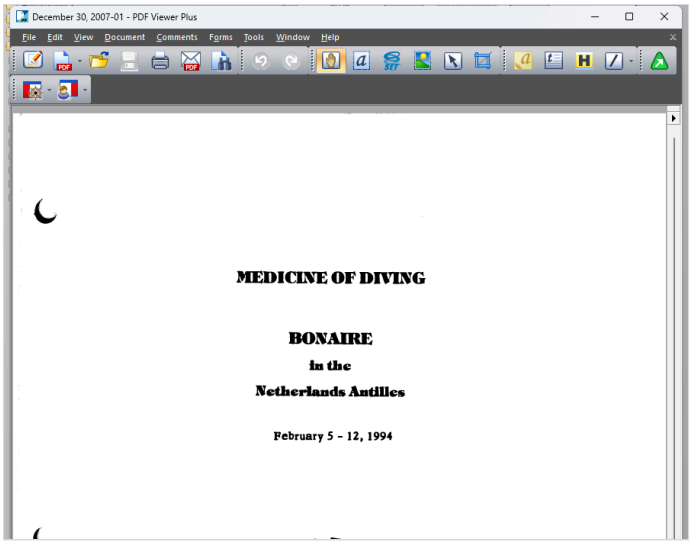
PaperPort's start figure is the time until its main window exists; a splash screen shows at about 2 s. Its viewer (PDF Viewer Plus) is a separate program that shows its own splash for roughly two seconds on every open; that is included in the 2.8 s because the page cannot be seen before it. ScanDesk's viewer appears at once; the 1.24 s is the time until the page, the page strip and the bookmark panel have all been painted and the picture has been still for a second. Timing scripts and raw results are kept with the project under tools□ench (Measure-PP2.ps1, Measure-PP3.ps1, Measure-ScanDesk3.ps1; bench-*.json).



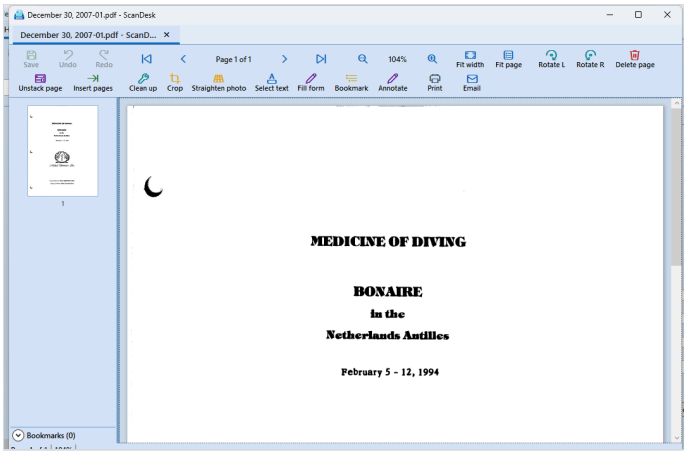
PaperPort 14.7, the 1994 folder (153 PDFs), 1.40 s after the click.



ScanDesk 0.7.3, the same folder, 0.18 s after the click.



PaperPort's PDF Viewer Plus, 3.1 s after the double-click.



ScanDesk's viewer, 1.24 s after the double-click.

SCANDESK-ONLY MEASUREMENTS (NO PAPERPORT EQUIVALENT WAS TIMED)

Operation	ScanDesk	Measured
Open a folder of 5,018 PDFs to first paint	0.5 s	2026-10-31, installed build, first-ever open about 1.5 s including the index sync
Full-text search, 100 hits with snippets, 5,018 documents	0.6 s	2026-10-31
Search by meaning over every indexed chunk	under 1 s	2026-11-02, about 1.5 µs per chunk, brute force
A file added or changed by another program appears in the grid	under 1 s	automated test asserts 2 s; PaperPort needs Refresh
OCR of a 300 dpi scanned page (background, low priority)	about 1 s	Tesseract 5, fast English model
Thumbnail of a 300 dpi scanned page	48 ms	rendered once, cached

3. Features, side by side

Yes = present and tested. Partial = a usable subset, noted. No = absent. PaperPort facts come from the 14.7 product and its documentation; ScanDesk facts from the 0.7.3 build, its 179 automated tests and hands-on checks.

DESKTOP, FOLDERS, ORGANIZING

Feature	PaperPort 14.7	ScanDesk 0.7.3
Folder Manager: point a named desktop folder at existing storage without moving files	Yes	Yes (File > Folder Manager; order, rename, unlink; nothing is ever moved)
Folder tree over real Windows folders; create, rename, move, delete to Recycle Bin	Yes	Yes
Thumbnails with first-page preview and page count; several sizes; details view	Yes	Yes, up to 320 px, virtualized (5,000 items tested)
Flip through pages on the thumbnail	Yes	Yes
Place an icon anywhere and it stays there; Arrange / Line Up / Auto Arrange	Yes	Yes (free placement is the default since 0.6.7)
New scans land at the end (arrival order)	Yes	Yes (default since 0.6.6; sort by name, date, size on request)
Stacks: drag one document onto another; Unstack; unstack one chosen page	Yes	Yes (viewer: Unstack page; desktop: Unstack the shown page)
Split desktop (two workspaces), drag between them	Yes	Yes
Workspace bookmarks	Yes	Named workspaces of the desktop arrangement; PDF bookmarks per page
Send To bar (email, print, Word, text, Explorer, your own programs and folders)	Yes	Yes, drag-and-drop onto a target
Reopen in the folder you were in, tree as you left it	Yes	Yes, also after a crash or forced close (saved 2 s after each change)
Changes made by other programs appear by themselves	No, Refresh / F5	Yes, live watcher, under 1 s
Folder colors; bulk folder creation from a list	Yes	Colors yes; bulk creation no
Document metadata (author, subject, keywords, notes)	Yes	Tags and full text; no custom fields
Ribbon with Quick Access Toolbar	Yes	Yes, tabs Home / Scan / Organize / PDF Tools / Automate plus classic menus

SCANNING AND CAPTURE

Feature	PaperPort 14.7	ScanDesk 0.7.3
TWAIN and WIA scanners, flatbed and feeder, duplex, device picker	Yes	Yes
A scanner driver crash cannot take the desktop down	No (32-bit, in-process drivers)	Yes, drivers run in separate 32- and 64-bit host processes
Scan profiles (color, dpi, size, duplex, clean-up, destination)	Yes, plus brightness/contrast/dropout	Yes, minus brightness/contrast/dropout at scan time (available afterwards in Clean up)
Blank-page removal; blank separator sheets split a batch	Yes	Yes (barcode separator sheets planned)
Scanner hardware button; ScanDirect / tray scanning	Yes	Yes (Still Image handler; tray icon, Ctrl+Alt+S)
Print any program into the desktop (image printer)	Yes, Kofax driver	Yes, Windows' own PDF driver plus a capture service; no driver to sign or install
Watched folders (DesktopDelivery)	Yes	Yes, any number, move or copy
Photo / camera perspective correction	Yes	Yes

VIEWING, EDITING, PDF

Feature	PaperPort 14.7	ScanDesk 0.7.3
Viewer: zoom, fit, page strip, rotate, delete, reorder, insert, merge, split	Yes (separate PDF Viewer Plus)	Yes, tabs, undo/redo, in the same program
Previous version kept on every save; undo until saved	Partial	Yes (.Versions beside the file)
Compare two documents side by side	No	Yes, compare pane, drag pages between them (copies, never moves)
Image clean-up: deskew, despeckle, punch holes, borders, crop, brightness, B&W, resize	Yes (SET tools)	Yes, before/after preview, per profile or on demand
Annotations, highlights, stamps, signatures; redaction	Yes	Yes; redaction really removes the text underneath
Make a scanned form fillable (FormTyper)	Yes	Yes (Fill form: PDF fields or blank lines on scans)
PDF passwords and permissions	Yes	Yes, AES-256
Reduce file size (MRC-style)	Yes	Yes, Standard or Maximum
Select and copy text from a page	Yes	Yes
PDF/A, PDF Create Assistant, portfolios	Yes (Power PDF Create)	No
Previews of Word, Excel, PowerPoint, CSV and text files on the desktop	Yes, via converters	Yes, the same preview Explorer shows; opens in the file's own program

OCR, SEARCH, AUTOMATION

Feature	PaperPort 14.7	ScanDesk 0.7.3
Searchable PDF (hidden text layer)	Yes, OmniPage	Yes, Tesseract 5, readable by Acrobat and Edge
OCR languages	Many, bundled	English bundled; others by dropping a language file in tessdata
Search by name, text, date, type, folder; results with page and snippet	Yes (All-in-One Search)	Yes, continuous background index, nothing to schedule
Ask in plain words ("what do I owe the cable company", "lease from two years ago")	No	Yes, a 23 MB language model runs on the PC; nothing leaves it
Suggested names (date, type, person) with a review queue	No	Yes, never applied without your Accept
Filing rules (sender, keywords, folder, tags) with preview and undo	No	Yes, review-only by design; Undo last filing
Duplicate finder (identical files, same text scanned twice, same look)	No	Yes, side-by-side compare before you delete
Quiet mode (no OCR, no suggestions, no assistant)	n/a	Yes, one tick
OCR to Word or text through Send To	Yes	Yes

FORMATS, MIGRATION, ADMINISTRATION

Feature	PaperPort 14.7	ScanDesk 0.7.3
Document storage	PDF, or proprietary .max for older scans; proprietary index	Plain PDF, TIFF, JPEG, PNG in normal folders; a disposable SQLite index that rebuilds itself
Old PaperPort .max files	Native	Converted to PDF with PaperPort's own converter (File > Convert old PaperPort .max files; batch, checked, originals kept); needs PaperPort on that PC
Cloud, SharePoint, FTP, Evernote connectors	Yes	No, by design (local only; Send To folder targets cover a network share)
Email with merge-to-one-attachment and size warning	Yes	Yes
Software updates	Manual download	Help > Check for updates from GitHub or a folder; SHA-256 and signature verified; centered prompt at start
Audit log of actions (user, time), exportable	No	Yes, CSV export
Crash safety: atomic saves, crash report on next start	n/a	Yes

Send feedback to the developer with logs (never document contents)	No	Yes, Help > Send feedback (your mail program or a GitHub issue)
Architecture	32-bit; several companion programs; printer driver and port monitor	64-bit .NET 8; one signed MSI (199 MB); per-monitor DPI aware
Network use	Optional cloud connectors	None, except the update check you start; no telemetry
Component licenses	Closed	MIT / BSD / Apache / LGPL only; GPL excluded; all listed in THIRD_PARTY.md
Installer signing	Vendor certificate	Office certificate (SmartScreen warns on a new PC until a public certificate is added)

4. Caveats

- Speed was measured on one PC and one folder of one-page scans. Bigger scans and slower disks change absolute numbers, not the order: both products read the same files from the same SSD.
- PaperPort was measured with the Folders pane open and the tree already expanded, which is how it is normally used; ScanDesk the same. PaperPort's own thumbnail cache was warm.
- ScanDesk's memory figure includes the PDF renderer, the search index and the thumbnail cache in one process; PaperPort spreads its work over several programs, only two of which were counted.
- Scanner throughput was not compared: it is set by the scanner, not the software. OCR quality was not compared in this report.
- ScanDesk's first start on a PC with an empty thumbnail cache is slower (2.5 s here); the cache is built once.

ScanDesk Desktop is built for Oculo-Facial Consultants; PaperPort Professional is a product of Tungsten Automation (formerly Kofax, Nuance). Version numbers as installed on 2026-11-02.